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Steve Heinke

June 7, 2026

Experimental economist working on the cognitive and behavioral foundations of decision-making, with a focus on financial decision-making, information processing, attention, and learning.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

02/2024–	Senior Researcher	Mobiliar Center for Resilience University of Fribourg
02/2017– 01/2024	Post-Doctoral Researcher	Center of Economic Psychology University of Basel
02/2011– 01/2017	Research & Teaching Assistant	Department of Economics University of Zurich

EDUCATION

2011–2016	PhD in Economics	University of Zurich
2008–2011	Master & Graduate Studies in Economics	University of Munich
2005–2008	BA Philosophy & Economics	University of Bayreuth

PUBLICATIONS

9. **The Elusive Neural Signature of Emotion Regulation Capabilities: Evidence from a Large-Scale Consortium** with Carmen Morawetz (PI), Maurizio Sicorello (first author), and an international consortium analyzing 40 fMRI datasets. Accepted at *Nature*, 2026.

8. **The Robustness of Mental Accounting Across 21 Countries** with Giulia Priolo (first author), Enrico Rubaltelli (PI), and research teams from 21 countries, *Journal of Consumer Research*, 2026.

7. **Mental Capabilities, Heterogeneous Trading Behaviour and Performance in an Experimental Asset Market**, with Andreas Hefti and Frédéric Schneider, *The Economic Journal*, 2025.

6. **Experiences, Demand for Risky Investments, and Implications for Price Dynamics**, with Sebastian Olschewski and Jörg Rieskamp, *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance*, 2025.

5. **Top–Down and Bottom–Up Information Acquisition: Applications to Financial Markets**, *Economics Letters*, 2024.

4. **Degree of Personal Responsibility in Decisions and Investment Abandonment**, with Kevin Trutmann and Celine Rudin, *Journal of Behavioral Finance*, 2023.

3. **Take Your Time: Delayed Information and Belief Formation**, with Kevin Trutmann and Jörg Rieskamp, *Finance Research Letters*, 2023.

2. **Cognitive Abilities Affect Decision Errors but not Risk Preferences: A Meta-Analysis**, with Tehilla Mechera-Ostrovsky et al., *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 2022.

1. **On the Economics of Superabundant Information and Scarce Attention**, with Andreas Hefti, Œconomia, 2015.

WORKING PAPERS (selected)

1. **Avoiding Bad Risks: The Role of Risk Aversion and Self-Control in Financial Decision-Making** with Silvia Maier, Alexander Ziegler, Alexandra Bagaïni, Isabella Kooij, Stephan Nebe, Nikita Sidorenko, Kevin Trutmann, Thorsten Hens, Rui Mata, Philippe N. Tobler, and Jörg Rieskamp. April 2026. Main paper of the interdisciplinary project "The Foundations of Successful Financial Decision Making". R&R at *PNAS Nexus*.

2. **What's Important Under the Hood? Decomposing Sequential Risk Taking with Feedback through Behavioral Structural Modeling** with Melvin Marti, Sebastian Olschewski, Kevin Trutmann, and Jörg Rieskamp. April 2026.

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3. **Too Much Choice? A Lab-in-the-Field Experiment on Choice Overload, Cognitive Constraints, and Consumer Welfare in Electricity Contracts Decisions** with Sebastian Olschewski and Catherine Roux. March 2026. R&R at *Journal of Economic Psychology*.

4. **How to Improve the Measurement Quality of Behavioral Tasks Eliciting Risk Preferences?** with O. Schürmann, S. Andraszewicz, and J. Rieskamp. 2026. R&R at *Scientific Reports*.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS (selected)

- **The Foundations of Successful Financial Decision Making**: multi-arm interdisciplinary program combining brokerage data, experimental tasks, and neuroimaging.
- **Learn Your Limits**.
  with Doron Cohen and Rudy de Winne.
  Manuscript in advanced preparation; analysis completed.

EDITORIAL, REFEREEING & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Editorial Board	Journal of Behavioral Decision Making (since 2023)
Refereeing	Management Science; Psychological Review; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Journal of Economic Psychology; Information Sicences; Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance; Finance Research Letters
University Service	Organizer, Public Lecture Series on Resilience, Reseach Colloquium (Fribourg) Organizer, Zurich Workshop on Economics (Zurich)
Committees	Senate Research Committee, University of Basel (2020–2024) Hiring Comittee, University of Zurich (2014)

INVITED SEMINARS

Columbia Business School; ETH Zurich; University of Warwick; University of Cambridge; University of Zurich; Maastricht University; Lund University.

CONFERENCES (selected)

ASSA; Experimental Finance Conferences; ESA Global Meetings; Subjective Probability, Utility and Decision Making (SPUDM); Foundations of Utility and Risk; Household Finance Workshops; Verein für Socialpolitik; Behavioral Measurment Conference; Generalizability and Replicability of Economic Experiments.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE (selected)

Lectures	Economic Psychology (since Spring 2024); Risk in Modern Life (since Fall
Seminars	Behavioral and Experimental Finance (Spring 2017–23); Empirical Project Seminar (2017, 2018); Economic History (2015); Contract Theory and Information Economics (2011, 2012)
Supervision	Master theses (8); Bachelor theses (34)

REFERENCES

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